# The Current Care Needs Checklist

What to observe, gather and ask before the next decision.

Mom came home from the hospital “needing more help.” Before anyone decides what that means, make sure you have these in hand. Check what you've done. Anything unchecked is a job for this week, not a verdict about Mom.

## Gather

- [ ] The latest discharge or care instructions, in writing, and a summary of her current health. [1]
- [ ] A full medication list: prescriptions, over-the-counter items, vitamins and supplements, with anything changed during the stay marked. [1]
- [ ] The names and phone numbers of the people to call with questions or concerns. [1]
- [ ] The therapies or services already involved, and their next dates.
- [ ] Any equipment that was recommended, and who is arranging it. [1]

## Observe

- [ ] What she does on her own this week, not before the hospital: bathing, dressing, using the bathroom, eating, moving between bed and chair, stairs. [1]
- [ ] The help she already gets, from whom, and when.
- [ ] How she gets around the house, and what she holds or uses to stand, sit and transfer.
- [ ] Changes in memory, mood or how she communicates, written as what you saw, not what you think it means.
- [ ] Anything about eating, swallowing, continence or skin that you want a professional to look at.

## Ask

- [ ] Her own account: what she feels she can do, and where she'd like help.
- [ ] Your questions for the clinician, written down. Keep medication questions separate, and change nothing on your own.
- [ ] The complications to watch for, and what to do about them. [1]
- [ ] Who you'd take each open question to: the doctor, the nurse, the pharmacist, the therapist, or a care consultant.

**What this checklist doesn't do**

It helps you gather and notice. It doesn't tell you what Mom needs or how much. That's for the people who assess her, and for the next step below.

## Ready for the next step?

You've gathered and noticed. The care interview walks you through Mom's situation area by area so nothing important is overlooked, and turns your answers into a Family Care Profile you can bring to any care conversation.

**Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›**

### WHERE THIS COMES FROM

Items marked 1 follow Medicare's discharge planning checklist; the rest come from the Family Care Roadmap's own working list for this step.


1. Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services, Your Discharge Planning Checklist (CMS Product No. 11376)
2. Family Caregiver Alliance, Hospital Discharge Planning: A Guide for Families and Caregivers


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